

NovaPay: UI/UX Design Description

Screen-by-Screen Experience Specification

Product & Design Blueprint

July 2026

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1. Design Principles

NovaPay’s interface is built around five principles that matter specifically for a cross-border money app:

- Clarity over cleverness.** Every screen involving money must show the exact amount, currency, and fee before the user confirms. No ambiguous rounding, no hidden steps.
- Trust through transparency.** Exchange rates, fees, and delivery times are always visible up front, never revealed only after a transaction completes.
- Speed to core actions.** The three most common actions — fund, convert, send — must be reachable in two taps or fewer from the home screen.
- Calm, not flashy.** Financial apps should feel steady and safe: restrained color, generous whitespace, no aggressive gamification.
- Local familiarity, global consistency.** Currency symbols, number formatting, and payout method names adapt to the user’s region, while the core navigation stays identical everywhere.

2. Visual Design System

2.1 Color palette

Role	Color	Usage
Primary	Deep navy #0D2B4E	Headers, primary buttons, key text
Accent	Vivid blue #1A73C1	Links, active states, highlights
Success	Green #1E9E5A	Completed transactions, positive balances
Warning	Amber #E0A314	Pending states, verification prompts
Error	Red #D64545	Failed transactions, alerts
Neutral background	Off-white #F7F9FB	App background
Neutral surface	White #FFFFFF	Cards, sheets
Text	Charcoal #1A1A1A / Gray #6B7280	Primary / secondary text

2.2 Typography

- **Headings:** A rounded-humanist sans-serif (e.g., Inter or General Sans), semi-bold, to feel modern but not cold.
- **Body:** Same family, regular weight, minimum 15px on mobile for legibility.
- **Numerals:** Tabular figures (fixed-width digits) everywhere money is displayed, so amounts align cleanly in lists and don't visually "jump."

2.3 Iconography & imagery

- Simple line icons (2px stroke), consistent corner radius across the icon set.
- Country flags used only next to currency codes, never as decoration, to avoid visual clutter.
- No stock photography inside the transactional flow — illustration only on empty states and onboarding.

2.4 Components

- Rounded cards (12–16px radius) for balances, transactions, and beneficiaries.
 - Bottom sheets (not full-screen modals) for quick actions like "Add money" or "Choose currency," keeping context visible behind a dimmed backdrop.
 - A persistent bottom tab bar: **Home, Cards, Send, Activity, Profile.**
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3. Core Screens

3.1 Onboarding & KYC

- **Welcome carousel** (3 screens): value proposition stated in one line each — "Hold multiple currencies," "Send money home instantly," "Spend abroad without hidden fees."
- **Sign-up:** phone number entry → OTP screen with auto-read on mobile → name/email → PIN or biometric setup.
- **KYC flow:** progress indicator ("Step 2 of 4"), document type selector (National ID / Passport / Driver's License), camera capture screen with an on-screen frame guide, then a selfie liveness check with clear real-time feedback ("Move closer," "Hold still"). A single confirmation screen shows all submitted info before final submit, with a visible "in review" status afterward rather than leaving the user guessing.

3.2 Home screen

- **Total balance summary** at top, showing net worth converted to the user's home currency, with a small toggle to switch the display currency.
- **Horizontal currency cards** below — one card per held currency (flag, code, balance, small daily change indicator if a "hold as savings" behavior is relevant). Swipeable, with an explicit "+" card at the end to add a new currency.
- **Quick actions row:** Add Money, Convert, Send, Card — large tappable icons, always visible without scrolling.
- **Recent activity** feed underneath, grouped by day, each row showing counterparty, amount in both currencies where relevant, and a status pill (Completed / Pending / Failed).

3.3 Add money (funding)

- Method selection screen: Mobile Money, Bank Transfer, Debit/Credit Card, each with a small note on expected speed ("Instant," "Within 10 minutes").
- Amount entry with a large numeric keypad and the currency clearly locked at the top.
- Confirmation screen showing amount, fee (or "no fee"), and total to be charged, before the user is redirected to the funding method's own authentication (e.g., mobile money PIN prompt).

3.4 Currency conversion

- Dual input fields: "You convert" and "You receive," with an inline swap icon between them.

- Live rate shown persistently below the fields (e.g., “1 USD = 1,560 NGN”), with a small countdown or refresh icon indicating the quote’s validity window.
- A single, unmistakable confirm button showing the exact receive amount, e.g., “Convert — Get ₦1,559,800.”

3.5 Send money

- **Recipient selection:** recent beneficiaries shown as avatars at the top; below, options to send to an Eversend-style in-app tag/phone number, a bank account, or a mobile money wallet.
- **Add beneficiary flow:** country selector first (this determines which fields appear next — IBAN for Europe, account number + bank list for African bank transfers, phone number + network for mobile money).
- **Amount + review screen:** shows send amount, fee, exchange rate if cross-currency, estimated arrival time, and total debited from the wallet — all on one screen, no surprises on the next.
- **Success screen:** checkmark animation (subtle, not celebratory-loud), transaction reference number, and a “Share receipt” option.

3.6 Cards

- **Card carousel** at the top showing virtual (and physical, if issued) cards as realistic card visuals with masked numbers.
- Tap a card to flip it and reveal full number/CVV (behind a biometric re-auth prompt), with copy-to-clipboard buttons.
- **Card controls panel** below: Freeze toggle, spend limit slider, “Fund card” shortcut, and a card-specific transaction list.
- **Create card flow:** choose funding currency → name the card (e.g., “Netflix,” “AWS”) → instant issuance confirmation.

3.7 Activity / transaction history

- Filterable by type (All, Sent, Received, Converted, Card spend) and by currency.
- Tapping any transaction opens a detail sheet: full breakdown of amount, fee, rate used, timestamps, status history (e.g., Initiated → Processing → Completed), and a “Get help with this transaction” link that pre-fills a support ticket.

3.8 Profile & settings

- Verification tier badge with a clear “Increase my limits” call to action if the user is below the top tier.
- Security section: PIN change, biometric toggle, device management (see and revoke logged-in devices), 2FA settings.
- Linked payout methods and saved beneficiaries management.
- Support: in-app chat entry point, FAQ, and a visible way to reach a human.

4. Key Interaction Patterns

- **Confirm-before-commit everywhere money moves.** No single-tap sends of new or large amounts; every money-movement action ends on an explicit review screen.
 - **Real-time status, not silence.** Pending states are shown with a visible pill and, where possible, a push notification the moment status changes — the app never leaves a transaction “hanging” with no feedback.
 - **Progressive disclosure for compliance.** KYC and limit-related prompts appear contextually (e.g., only when a user tries an action above their tier), not as a wall of forms at signup.
 - **Error states are specific.** “Insufficient USD balance — add \$12.40 more to complete this” rather than a generic “Transaction failed.”
 - **Biometric re-auth on sensitive reveals**, such as viewing full card numbers or changing a payout beneficiary, to protect against shoulder-surfing and device takeover.
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5. Accessibility & Localization

- Minimum contrast ratio of 4.5:1 for all text, verified against the palette above.
 - Full VoiceOver/TalkBack labeling on all interactive elements, with amounts read as “one hundred fifty-six US dollars,” not raw digit strings.
 - Support for right-to-left layouts is not required initially (no core markets use RTL), but text and currency-amount components should be built with logical (not fixed left/right) alignment so it can be added later without a rebuild.
 - Number, date, and currency formatting localized per device region, independent of app display language.
 - Minimum tap target size of 44x44pt throughout, given how frequently the app is used one-handed while walking or in transit.
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6. Empty, Error, and Edge States to Design For

State	Design requirement
No transaction history yet	Friendly illustration + “Add money to get started” CTA
KYC rejected	Clear reason shown, plus a direct re-submission path
Payout failed after debit	Immediate reversal notice with new balance shown, not just an apology message
Rate expired mid-confirmation	Auto-refresh with a visible “Rate updated” toast, requiring re-confirmation
No internet connectivity	Cached last-known balances shown, clearly labeled “Last updated X min ago”
Card declined	Reason surfaced where available (insufficient funds, merchant restriction, frozen card)

7. Suggested Tools & Deliverables

- **Wireframes:** low-fidelity flows in Figma covering onboarding, funding, conversion, and send-money, validated with 5–8 target users before high-fidelity design.
- **High-fidelity UI kit:** a shared Figma component library matching the design system in Section 2, so engineering can build against named, versioned components rather than one-off screens.
- **Prototype:** a clickable Figma prototype of the send-money and card-creation flows for usability testing before development starts on those modules.
- **Design QA:** a pass against real device sizes (small Android phones remain the majority device class across target markets) before each release.